in a single attack on Jagannath Hall. Several well-known professors, both Hindu and Muslim, were murdered. Hundreds of thousands of women were systematically raped in the countryside. By September 1971, ten million refugees had poured into eastern India. Although this was one of the worst genocides in human history, it is barely remembered by the rest of the world. *Time* magazine of August 1971 quoted a US official saying 'This is the most incredible, calculated thing since the days of the Nazis in Poland'.[16] The article goes on to describe the streams of refugees who were pouring into India, carrying with them their few remaining possessions, their children and the infirm:

> They are silent, except for a child whimpering now and then, but their faces tell the story. Many are sick and covered with sores. Others have cholera, and when they die by the roadside there is no one to bury them. The Hindus, when they can, put a hot coal in the mouths of their dead or singe the body in lieu of cremation. The dogs, the vultures and the crows do the rest. As the refugees pass the rotting corpses, some put pieces of cloth over their noses.

The response of the international community to the massacres was shameful. The Chinese premier Chou En-lai sent a letter of support to the Pakistan government and even hinted at military support should the 'Indian expansionists dare to launch aggression against Pakistan'. Meanwhile, the Western world was aware of what was happening. We now have copies of desperate cables sent by diplomat Archer Blood and his colleagues at the US consulate in Dacca (now Dhaka) pleading with the US government to stop supporting a military regime that was carrying out genocide.[17] Instead, President Nixon concentrated on threatening Indira Gandhi to stay out. He would even send the US Seventh Fleet to cow her down.

Fortunately, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi held her ground and began to prepare for war. Strengthened by promises of support from the US and China, Pakistan's military commanders ordered pre-emptive air strikes against India on 3 December 1971. The next morning, the *Statesman* newspaper carried the headline 'It's War'. The Indian response was swift and sharp. With support from the civilian population as well as the Mukti Bahini, an irregular army of Bengali rebels, the Indian army swept into East